

6 Simple Tips for Buying Great Affordable Wine



On a budget? Not wanting it to get in the way of a great wine and food pairing? Help is on the way. I was able to convince award-winning wine consultant Brad Haskel to share some of his inside industry knowledge.

Shopping for good wine without background knowledge can be intimidating. Everybody wants great flavor and good value, but where do you start? Wandering through the aisles of my friendly wine and spirits store with that “deer in the headlights”

look has been my approach in the past. I don’t recommend it, however, particularly in this economy. Dishing out for a special dinner or dessert wine when pennies are dear can feel like a major investment, and nobody wants to feel let down by an uninformed choice. Here are six simple recommendations from Brad.

1. Search out hidden gems

Look for wines from lesser-known regions like Argentina, Austria, Greece, South Africa, Israel, and Long Island. The world of wine is packed with terrific offerings that are sold at great prices. Some of the best values are not from the uber-trendy regions, but the countries and regions that focus on sustainability over commercial wine production. Undiscovered regions produce some of the world’s best wines, inflated price tag not included.

2. Trick of the trade

Read the back label. Wine importers are often listed on the back labels of wine bottles, so seeking out the ones you trust is one simple trick that even the professionals use to make smart selections. Some of the more popular importers that offer great wines at